Curriculum Vitae

Current affiliation: TU Wien (Senior Postdoc)
Address: Rasumofskygasse 12/8, 1030 Vienna, Austria
Mail: dibartolomeo.sara@gmail.com | sdb@ac.tuwien.ac.at
Scholar profile: https://scholar.google.com/citations?hl=en&user=VAiOmIQAAAAJ
Languages: Italian (native), English (fluent, C2), German (basic knowledge).

Education

Northeastern University, Boston, USA: Ph.D. in Computer Science.
Advisor: Cody Dunne
Dates: September 2018 to May 2023
Research focus: Data Visualization, Graph Layout Algorithms, Temporal Event Sequence Visualization, Virtual Reality.
Thesis title: Layered Graphs and Their Layouts, Evaluations, and Applications

La Sapienza University of Rome, Italy: Master of Science in Computer Science and Engineering
Graduation date: January 2018
Graduation mark: 110 cum laude
Excellence Path Award
Thesis title: Ontology extraction and population from user-generated text on online marketplaces

La Sapienza University of Rome, Italy: Bachelor of Science in Computer Science and Engineering
Graduation date: March 2015
Graduation mark: 100/110

Positions held to date and work experience

TU Wien, Vienna, Austria: Senior Postdoc
Dates: September 2024 - ongoing
Funded under FWF ESPRIT project “Simultaneous Multiprojection Graph Visualization”.

University of Konstanz, Germany: Postdoc
Dates: July 2023 - August 2024
Taught "Advanced Topics in Data Visualization" for Master’s students, and "Basic Topics in Data Visualization" for Bachelor’s students.
Lead a small group of 3 PhD students, mentoring them and helping them in their research.

Microsoft Research, Redmond (WA), USA: Research intern
Dates: May 2022 - August 2022
Worked on the usage of data comics to represent network incidents, advised by Nathalie Henry-Riche.

INRIA, Paris, France: Research intern
Dates: June 2021 - September 2021
Studied layout algorithms for hypergraphs, advised by Prof. Jean-Daniel Fekete.
The resulting work has been presented as a full paper to EuroVis in June 2022.

Northeastern University, Boston, USA: PhD Student
Dates: September 2018 – June 2023
Obtained my PhD, advised by Prof. Cody Dunne.

Focused on event sequence visualization and graph drawing.
Teaching assistant for CS7250 Data Visualization during Spring 2020 and Spring 2021.

La Sapienza University of Rome, Italy: Research Assistant
Dates: January 2018 – August 2018
Assisted on implementation work and writing for scientific publications.

Google Summer of Code, The Processing Foundation, Remote: Mentor
Dates: May 2018 – August 2018
Mentored a student who worked on APDE, a Processing IDE that runs on Android.

Google Summer of Code, The Processing Foundation, Remote: Developer
Dates: June 2017 – September 2017
Developed a VR application to showcase the capabilities of Processing on Android. The application displays a Virtual Reality landscape procedurally built according to music.

Codemotion, Rome, Italy: Coding teacher
Dates: March 2015 – June 2017
Taught coding classes to children aged 7 to 17.
Used gamification as a teaching tool using a number of different technologies such as Scratch, Arduino, Blender, Minecraft, Processing, Python, Lego Mindstorms.

Awards and Honors

2025 Best paper honorable mention at VIS 2025
2025 Best paper at EuroVis 2025 + honorable mention for best paper at the same venue on two separate publications.
2024 Best Dissertation at EuroVis 2024.
2022 Selected as one of the Huntington 100, the 100 best students at Northeastern University in 2022.
2018 Google Summer of Code (500 €)
2017 Excellence Path at M.Sc. in Computer Science at La Sapienza (3000 €) - awarded to the 10 top students in the last year of courses based on GPA.
2017 Google Summer of Code (6000 €)
2015 1st Prize for Graphics and 2nd prize for Gameplay at Global Game Jam Rome
2014 1st Prize at Cleanweb Hackathon Rome (1500 €)
2013 1st Prize for Fun, 6th prize for Coolness at Ludum Dare 28

Commissions of trust

PC member: ITAVIS 2020, VISGuides workshop at VIS 2022, EuroVis 2023 and 2024 short papers, EuroVis STARS 2025 and 2026, PacificVis 2024, Graph Drawing 2025 and 2026, alt.vis workshop 2023 and 2025.

Organization: alt.vis workshop (VIS 2023, VIS 2025), Graph Drawing Contest 2024, 2025 and 2026.

Reviewing: I regularly review for EuroVIS, VIS, CHI, PacificVIS and Graph Drawing since 2020.

Other services: Northeastern University PhD hiring committee member, 2019

Previous and current cooperation partners

I frequently collaborate with fellow scientists from all over the world. I especially keep in contact with other researchers with whom I share research interests and affiliations. I keep active collaborations with my past colleagues at Northeastern University, at the University of Konstanz, and recently

started new collaborations with the Graph Drawing group at the University of Perugia and at TU Munich.

Acquired Third-Party Funding

2024 FWF ESPRIT Grant (2024-2027), Project: “Simultaneous Multiprojection Graph Visualization”, € 316.000, role: PI
2022 Northeastern Dissertation Completion Fellowship (15.000 $)

Scientific talks

Academic talks

Guest Lecture: Information Visualization Perspective on Network Visualization, , Universität Wien, Vienna, Austria, October 2025

PhD School at Graph Drawing 2025: Information Visualization Perspective on Network Visualization, Linköping University, Norrköping, Sweden, September 2025

Guest Lecture: Introduction to Data Visualization, Université d’Antananarivo, Madagascar, October 2023

Guest Lecture: Graph Layout algorithms for layered graphs Masaryk University, Brno, Czech Republic, August 2022

(Non-Academic) Public appearances

You Turing-Complete Me Codemotion Rome 2016 + Google DevFest Bari, Italy 2017 + Campus Party, Milan, Italy 2017

Clustering reddit: learning from the front page of the internet Data Driven Innovation Rome 2017, February 2017

Let there be light: Introduction to GLSL Linux Day 2017, Rome, October 2017

Raiders of the lost reviews Machine Learning and Data Science Meetup, Rome, Italy, December 2017

Teaching and mentoring

TU Wien: Seminar for Master Students in Logic and Computation, Winter 2024 and Winter 2025.

University of Konstanz: Taught the course "Advanced Topics in Data Visualization" (for Masters’students) at the University of Konstanz in Winter 2023, and "Basic Topics in Data Visualization" (for Bachelor’s students) in Spring 2024.

Northeastern University: Teaching Assistant for CS7250 Data Visualization (Graduate Level) for two semesters, Spring 2020 and Spring 2021. My tasks included grading assignments, holding office hours, helping with creating assignments and grading tables, helping students with their final projects, and holding two classes on d3 and javascript. The final projects from these two courses resulted in four short paper submissions at VIS 2020 and VIS 2021, two of which have been accepted and published.

Codemotion, Rome: I taught and designed coding courses for children and teenagers (7 to 17) between March 2015 and June 2017 in Rome with Codemotion Kids, the company I worked for.

Supervision experience

I have regularly mentored and supervised younger students throughout my career, at either Bachelor, Master's, and PhD level. I have not yet had PhD students of my own. Recent examples are Tommaso Piselli, a visiting PhD student from the University of Perugia, whom I mentored and with whom the collaboration resulted in a full paper that received honorable mention for best paper at VIS 2025, and Johann Sebastian Schicho, a Master's student I hired as a research assistant to help out on a current research project we plan to submit to EuroVIS 2026. As a postdoc at the university of Konstanz I was also in charge of supervising a small group of 3 PhD students, doing regular weekly supervision meetings and guiding them in their research work.